

WHAT THEY SAID...

« I don't think I can say this on camera, but I was s****ing myself at the end. But we still had a couple of batters to come, so I was confident we could get over the line. But in moments like these and big games, it's more about holding your composure, which we all know about. It's not easy, but I'm happy to win this and get over the line this time. I think I've batted in times like these in three out of the five games. – K. L. Rahul »



« "It's always amazing to win an ICC event, and especially the Champions Trophy. I remember 2017

very closely to my heart. We could not finish the job that time. But very, very pleased with the way we have played throughout the tournament. And, at the same time, how everyone contributed. That was fantastic.

– Hardik Pandya »



« "I was a sudden inclusion, and I didn't expect it to turn out like this, and it's a dream come true. – Varun Chakaravathy »

« "Feeling ecstatic, to be honest. It's ineffable. It's my first ICC trophy, and I'm kind of overwhelmed.

Looking at everyone in the dressing room, how we've turned up for this tournament, and how we've progressed, it was simply magnificent. – Shreyas Iyer »



« "Felt amazing. For the most part, I was sitting back and enjoying Rohit bhai's batting but we kept talking to each other and the [opening] partnership was important for us. It's definitely very satisfying, we missed out on the last one that we played in 2023 [World Cup], and it's a surreal feeling to win this one, starting with the ODI series in England, winning eight ODIs back-to-back, amazing feeling. – Shubman Gill »



« "My batting number is such that I'm either a hero or a zero [on finishing India's matches often]. Hardik and KL had a good partnership in the last 10 overs because the wicket was not so easy for new batters, but the partnership they had changed the momentum of the game. – Ravindra Jadeja »



« "Luckily [I didn't have to bat]. Credit goes to KL bhai and Jaddu bhai to finish the game. There are certainly a lot of expectations when you're playing well over the years, and you enter the tournaments as favourites, although I don't believe in the favourites' tag. I dedicate this win to the fans. – Kuldeep Yadav »